LIFTOFFR

The Bear Market *Buy Zone* Plan

How I decide when the bottom is forming, where I place my buys, and when the window closes — the same framework I'm running with my own money right now. July 2026 edition.

1 · The bottom is a zone, not a price

Nobody nails the exact low — I certainly haven't. In 2022 I sat in my dorm room between two college classes and watched $30K disappear because I had no plan for either direction. What history *does* repeat: in the 2015, 2018 and 2022 bear markets, Bitcoin's low formed **at or below the 200-week moving average**. That line is the anchor. Everything below builds on it.

2 · The four buy bands (anchored to the 200W MA)

Instead of one "bottom call," I pre-define four bands as multiples of the 200-week MA. The MA moves — recompute monthly. As of July 2026 the 200W MA sits near **$62.5K**, so:

BAND	TRIGGER (× 200W MA)	JULY 2026 EXAMPLE	WHAT IT HAS MEANT HISTORICALLY
Band 1	0.97×	~$60,700	Price reaches the MA — value territory begins
Band 2	0.85×	~$53,200	Typical bear-market undershoot
Band 3	0.73×	~$45,600	Deep-value zone of past cycle lows
Band 4	0.65×	~$40,600	Capitulation extreme — rare, brief

> BTC traded near **$61.6K** as this was written — already inside Band 1. Deeper bands may never fill. That's the point of the split: you don't need the exact low, you need exposure across the zone.

3 · The capital split

Decide your total accumulation budget for the bear *first* — money you won't need for 4+ years. Then split it:

BUCKET	ALLOCATION	HOW IT DEPLOYS
Baseline weekly DCA	**50%**	Every week, no matter what, until the window closes
Band 1 tranche	**20%**	Limit order / manual buy at 0.97× MA
Band 2 tranche	**15%**	At 0.85× MA
Band 3 tranche	**10%**	At 0.73× MA
Band 4 tranche	**5%**	At 0.65× MA

The DCA half guarantees you accumulate even if the deeper bands never print. The tranche half guarantees the crash you're afraid of becomes the buying opportunity you planned for.

4 · Confirmation signals (don't buy the falling knife blind)

- ✓ **LiftOffr Score below 40** — accumulation zone (below 20 = aggressive). It's at **26 right now**. Free live read: liftoffr.com/cycle
- ✓ **CBBI below 30** — composite of 9 cycle indicators (currently ~26)
- ✓ **Fear & Greed under 25** for multiple weeks — sentiment washout
- ✓ **Price at/below the 200W MA** — the historical value line

Three or more at once = the zone is open. One alone = wait.

5 · When the window closes

- → Score climbs back **above 40** and holds for 3+ weeks
- → Price reclaims the 200W MA and holds it as support
- → Cancel unfilled deeper-band orders, keep the baseline DCA, and switch your attention to the *exit* framework — that's a different checklist (I have one).

6 · The rules that save you from yourself

1. **Write the plan before the crash.** Decisions made mid-panic are the ones I've paid $30K to learn about.
2. **Limit orders, not willpower.** Pre-place the tranche buys. The best fills happen at 3am when you're asleep.
3. **No leverage. Ever.** The zone can go 20% deeper than any model. Spot survives that; leverage doesn't.
4. **Withdraw to a hardware wallet.** Bear markets kill exchanges (I lived through NiceHash and FTX). Not your keys, not your coins.
5. **4-year money only.** If you might need it sooner, it doesn't belong in the plan.

Numbers are July 2026 snapshots; recompute bands against the current 200-week MA.